A-A-51692
26 September 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CASE, NEEDLE AND BLADE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers two sizes of sterile plastic cases suitable for the counting and disposal of suture needles and blades in a sterile field.

Salient characteristics:

Sizes. Cases shall be provided in the sizes shown in Table I, as specified.

TABLE I. Case sizes

Size	Capacity		Case dimensions (centimeters) (cm)		
	Needles	Blades	Length	Width	Depth
1	30	4-6	9.0-11.0	6-8.5	1.5-2.0
2	60	6-8	9.0-10.5	11-13	1.5-2.0

Style and design. The case shall consist of a rigid puncture-proof container with a ridged foam insert. The container shall be of the dimensions shown in Table I for the size specified. The container shall be hinged and shall have a snap-lock closure. The foam insert shall have a minimum of two tabs which protrude 0.4-0.6 cm outside of the container on the snap-lock side and shall be hinged. The insert shall have 2-3 ridges 0.6-0.8 cm high on each side. The insert shall have parallel lines printed perpendicular to the ridges. Each needle insertion site, formed by the intersection of a line with a ridge, shall be numbered. There shall be 15 sites on each side of the size 1 insert and 30 sites on each side of the size 2 insert. The insert shall have a magnetic strip permanently attached on each side. The magnetic strips shall be capable of securely holding the number of blades indicated in Table I for the size specified. The strips shall be labeled "Blades." The container shall have an adhesive strip applied on the bottom side. The adhesive strip may be applied across the width or length of the container. The adhesive strip shall be capable of adhering the container firmly to a metallic surface.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Markings. The case shall bear the manufacturer's name or registered trademark.

Materials. The container shall be manufactured from transparent styrene or an equivalent plastic. The insert shall be manufactured from polyurethane foam, reinforced with paperboard, and colored for clear visibility of needles.

Sterility. The case shall be sterile when tested in accordance with the United States Pharmacopiea (USP).

Workmanship. The case shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform in quality and free from defects that will affect life, serviceability, or appearance.

Product Quality Level.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing twelve cases of one size only, individually packaged sterile in a peel-open type container, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for visual examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Level 2, AQL of 4.0. The unit of product for examination shall be one disposal system.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-174-2394	CASE, NEEDLE AND BLADE, Counting and Disposal System, 6.4 by 11 cm, 12s
6515-01-174-9906	CASE, NEEDLE AND BLADE, Counting and Disposal System, 11 by 12 cm, 12s

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-3565

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51692	CASE, NEEDLE AND BLADE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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